

- India $\rightarrow$ Thick seam = 4.8m.
- Ground control measures needed to be done.

• B.P. $\rightarrow$ pillar crush, vent issue.

LW $\rightarrow$ better option.

ICC $\rightarrow$ contain within 1.5°C , change in temperature

O/C $\rightarrow$ SR, maintenance of slope angle, high waste handle cost,
high slope $\rightarrow$ less waste, but stability issues.

Beyond 300m depth $\{$ thick seams

* Ground Control & Rock Mechanics Aspect of Thick Seam Mining.

- W/H ratio.
- Natural pressure arch.
- Pillar Spalling.
- en-masse caving.
- natural caving.
- caving angle.
- abutment angle.

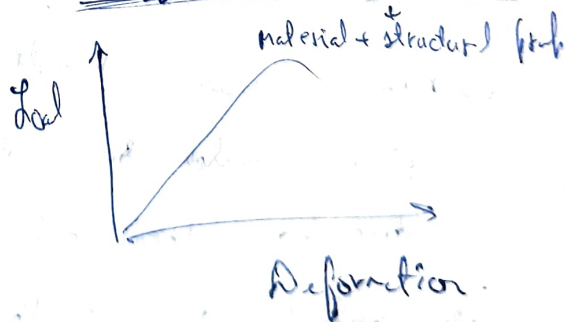
① Same w_1

$$\rightarrow h_1 < h_2 < h_3$$



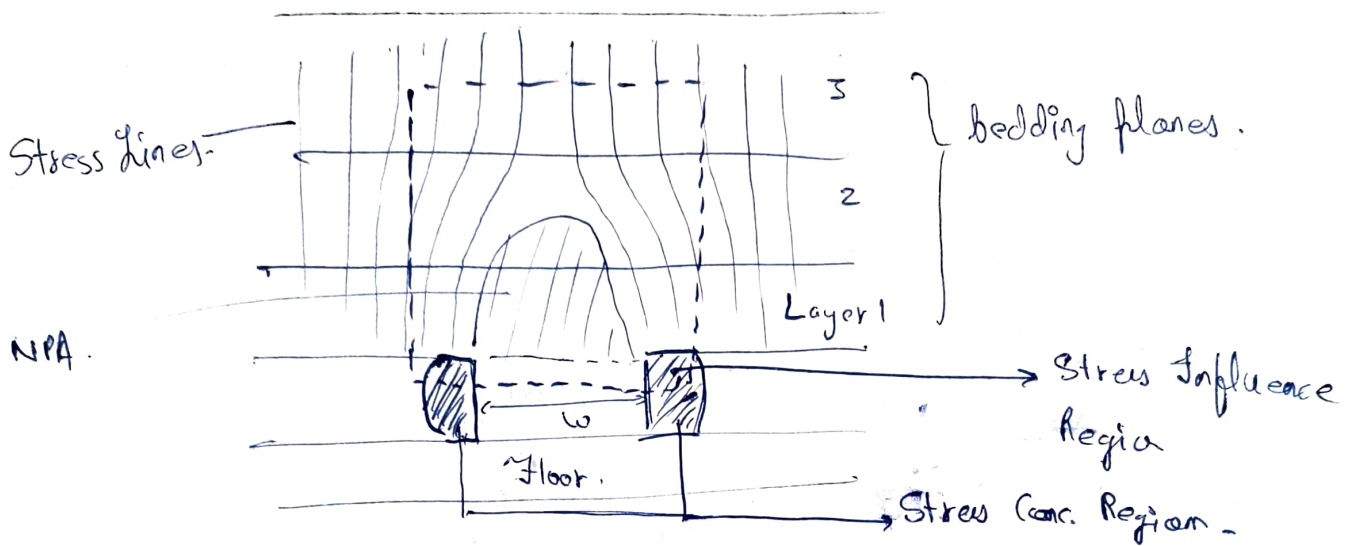
$\uparrow$ in pillar strength $\&$ $K \downarrow$

$\rightarrow$ stiffness parameter.



$\rightarrow$ modulus $\rightarrow$ material prop

② Natural Pressure Arch.

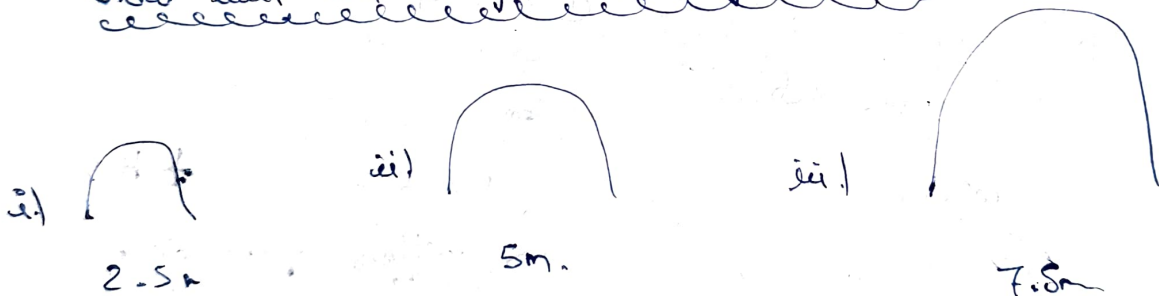


• NPA → Stress Relaxed Zone, Pressure Arch.

→ Zero load capacity, it transfers to surrounding. { stress conc. Region }

• Main Roof Immediate Roof { bedding planes is different }

How will NPA change with change in h ?



→ NPA increases in height & curve.

→ pillar should be able to withstand the stress generated due to stress relaxed zone.

→ beyond 400, ↑ thickness, hard for B & P. to be maintained.

④ En-masse Caving

↳ high volume caving.

~~$$BF = \frac{H_c}{H} + \frac{h_c}{H} \cdot \frac{h}{H}$$~~

$$h_c = \frac{h}{k-1}$$

$h_c \rightarrow$ caving height.

$k \rightarrow$ bulk factor

$h \rightarrow$ ht. of working.

$$k \rightarrow 1.06 - 1.8$$

→ for Indian geomining condition.

h	$k=1.1$
2.5	25
5	50
7.5	75

as ht. of working increases, height of caving also increases.

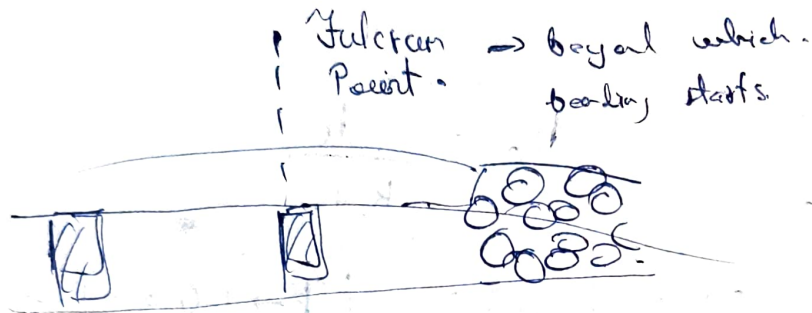
h	$k=1.06$	$k=1.06$
2.5	92	$\frac{2.5}{1.06-1}$
5	83	$\frac{5}{1.06-1}$
7.5	125	

$$BF = \frac{\text{change in vol}}{\text{original vol.}}$$

④ Nature of caving

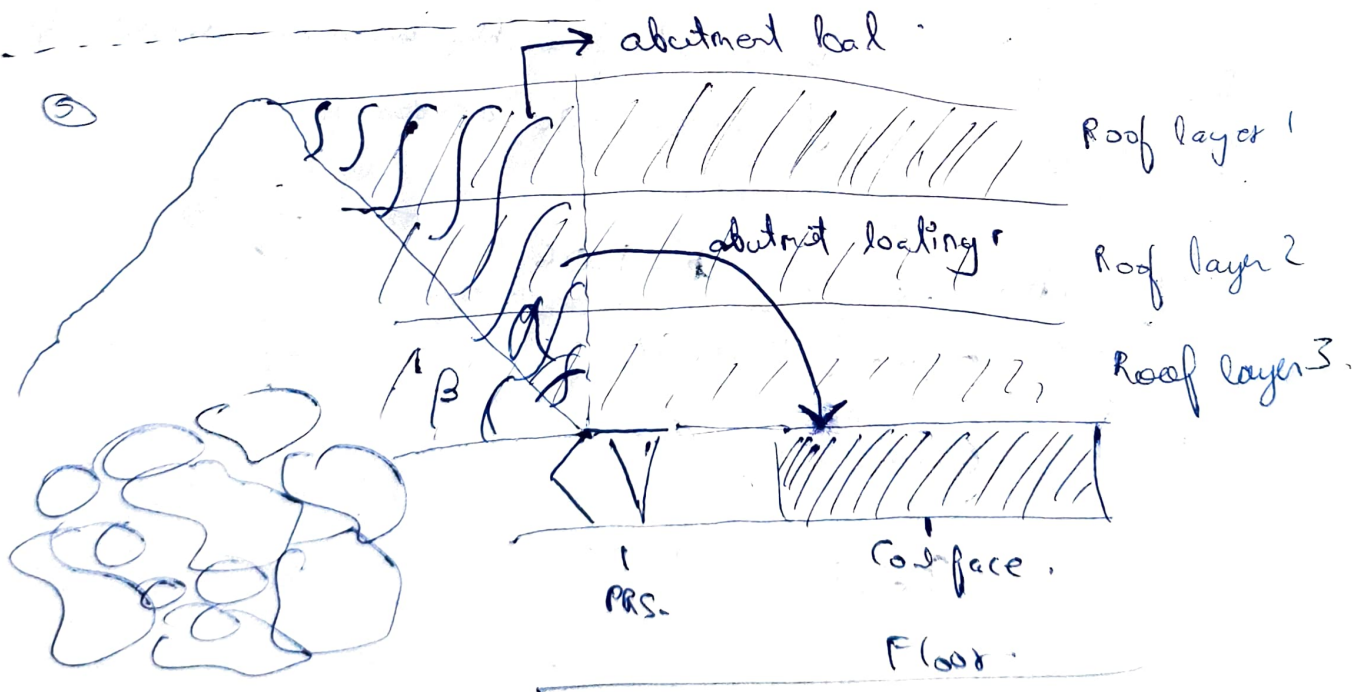
① Bulking factor controlled caving.

② Parting factor caving. $\rightarrow$ larger overhang $\rightarrow$ caved material, doesn't touch main roof



- bulking caving is more favourable..
- more overhang, face fall, without leaching.
- good BF, want propagate above, the caving.

• main & strata weighting



Caved Material.

$\beta \rightarrow$ caving angle

$\alpha \rightarrow$ abutment angle.

• Caving depends on strain, lamination.

• α can't be equal to 0.

* Poor caving, $\beta \downarrow$, then load on pillar $\uparrow$.

($\beta > \alpha$) is a necessity

• General Caving Para $\rightarrow \alpha, \beta$ discuss

EXAM

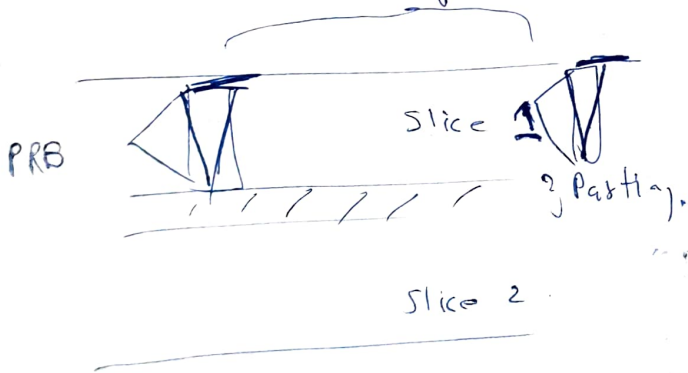
• Generalized $\Rightarrow$ ppt.

POV.

13/12/25 :-

Problems of running thick coal seams

• Multi-seam mining :- for very thick seams.
goaf.



① Slice 1
Slice 11

② Slice 11
Slice 1
back filling

Cat. Deformation

Fracture

cave



$\frac{1}{2}(2-8)h$

• mine, then stress redistribution

• method selection depend on many condition, economy.

• Parting should withstand the load due to caving. { thickness of parting }

• Thicker seam, high E storage, when released $\Rightarrow$ coal seam

• Overriding of Pillar $\Rightarrow$ at high CI.

$\Rightarrow$ high stress, higher depth

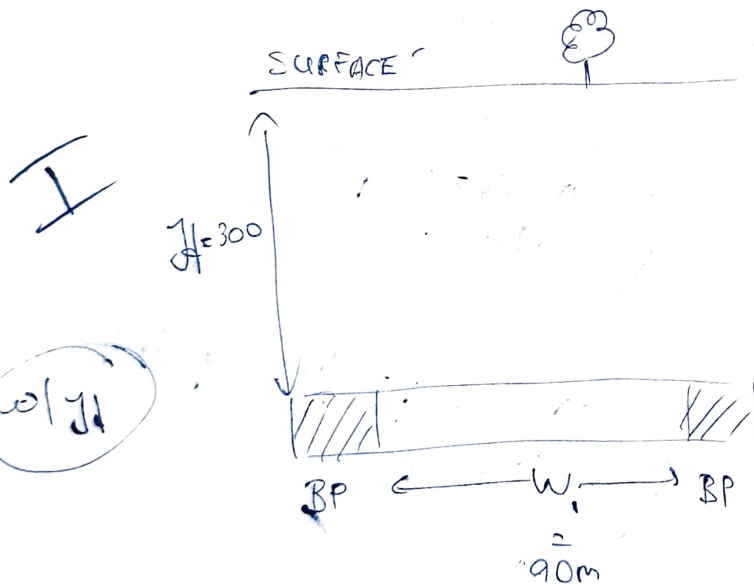
• Stagnant Ventilation $\Rightarrow$ methane layering.

[thick $\rightarrow$ more coal in layer]
 $\rightarrow$ more gas

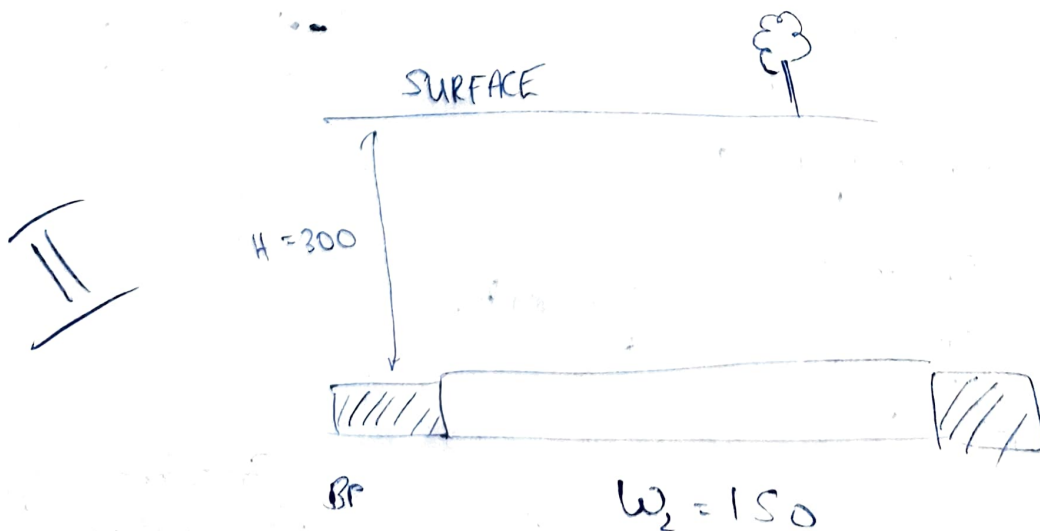
• Hooridish.

• 2-sm Jd.

• Magnitude of subsidence is high.



$$w/H = 0.3$$



$$w/H = 0.5$$

$\Rightarrow w/H < 1 \Rightarrow \text{Sub Critical.}$

$w/H = 1 \Rightarrow \text{Critical}$

$w/H > 1 \Rightarrow \text{Super-Critical}$

NEW $\Rightarrow$ effect of caving does not translate to surface $\left\{ w/H = 0.2 - 0.8 \right\}$

$w/H \rightarrow h$ is not considered.

$\rightarrow$ higher h value influences rate of subsidence, higher influence zone.

$\Rightarrow w/H$ define subsidence extent.
 h defines rate of subsidence.

Geologic ~~gradient~~ constraint and gradient

$\rightarrow$ Extreme characterization & study to be conducted before longwall mining.

15/1/2025 :-

Longwall Mining

- Brief description
- Applicability.
- Design parameters.
- Strata mechanics

Optimal parameter for designing LW working

→ It is site specific

- Mechanisation / automation in LW working
- Case Study { India & Abroad }
- Consideration for designing high capacity LW.

X

• PRS width $\rightarrow 1.5 - 2.0m$.

• development, extraction.

→ along dip-rise direction / strike direction.

→ stowing not common, mostly LW with caving.

→ Chain Pillar $\rightarrow$ with crosscuts $\rightarrow$ multiple entries $\rightarrow$ better ventilation (more quantity) flexible

Barrier Pillar

Yield Pillar $\rightarrow$ width less, extraction, low strength

Haunter $\rightarrow$ Stage Loader, all machineries, so we use chain pillar, face caving

$\rightarrow$ 30m free face $\Rightarrow$ support by hydraulic props.

$\rightarrow$ Yield Pillar design when we require higher extraction.

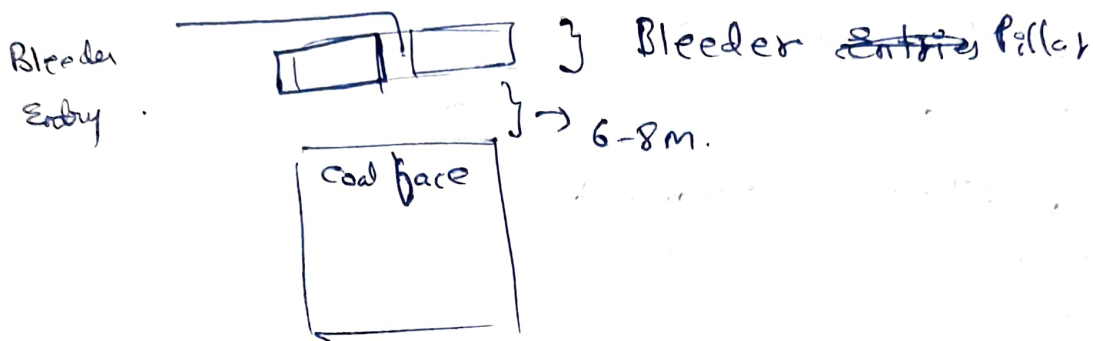
$\rightarrow$ Better times $\rightarrow$ Development & bolting same time.

Salvaging Operation $\rightarrow$ moving machineries to other panel,

$\rightarrow$ 2-3 months } minimize it

 $\rightarrow$ flaming $\rightarrow$ bolt, mesh

We prefer weak LW face.; less salvage time.



* Panel Dimensions } decides extent of fracture zone.
 Rate of advance }

APPLICABILITY :-

→ Reserve

→ Geology

→ Seam characteristics. dip (1 in 3) thickness (0.6-6).
 → roof and floor strata.
 → geological anomalies.

+ thickness uniform in panel.

AT 1-8 2-5.

3.8 → Chhona

4.8 → Kholatoli

4.5 → Thajra

Shearer } requirement??
 Plough }

Roof & floor Strd.

→ Roof easily caving.

→ Floor → floor leave - & penetrates

→ + load transferred to it through face and roof.

Strain } defers massive.
 Thickness } roof.

① Induced blasting.

② Size of opening such that fracture & its propagation is behind face.

16/11/2025:-

• Negation of geological anomaly is time consuming

• Cover Depth $\rightarrow > 200m$

BHP $\rightarrow$ deep, pillar size $\uparrow$, recovery $\downarrow$

$\rightarrow$ ventilation has to reach multiple faces.

$\rightarrow$ huge quantity required.

Width $\rightarrow 360 - 500m$

India $\rightarrow 250m$

Length $\rightarrow 3500 - 7000m$

2.5km.

• Suppose 2km length and at 600m, fault $\rightarrow$ extract till 550m, 50m coal left for support.

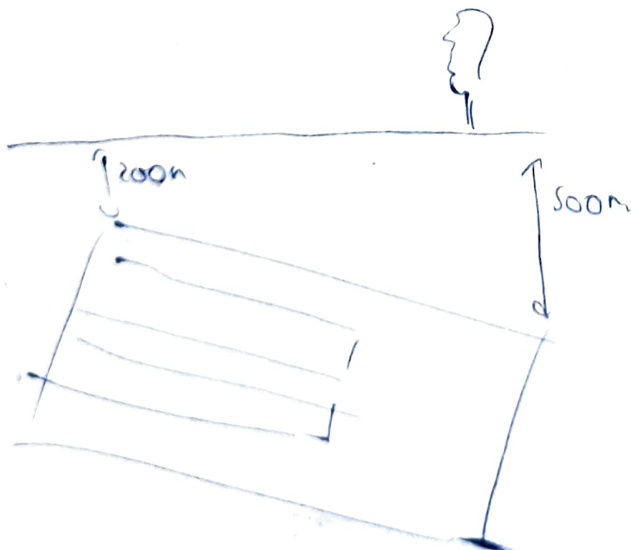
• Strength of Coal?

req. cutting $\rightarrow$ soft to medium.

$\rightarrow$ stock control pov
 $\rightarrow$ production pov.

• Gestation Period $\approx 1-5$ years for single panel

$$NEW \Rightarrow \frac{w}{H} \Rightarrow 0.2 - 0.8$$



$$\frac{150}{200} = 0.75$$

minimum

$$\frac{3}{10} = 0.3$$

• $\frac{w}{H}$ $\rightarrow$ we consider minimum depth as max depth underestimates

NEW, no consideration of the strata above.

Subsidence

Deformation

Strain

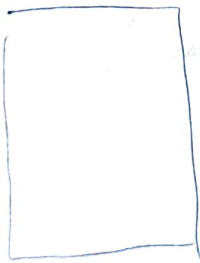
Advancing → selfrost of gderal throughout. } → geology cannot be explored.
→ blind heading, & development. }
→ efficiency ↓ } may halt face advance
→ sluggish ventilation.

Retreating :-

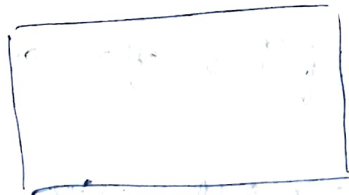
→ Longwall Requirement → face has to keep moving.

Different Parameters of LW

Face
Length
(b)



Face (a)
Advance



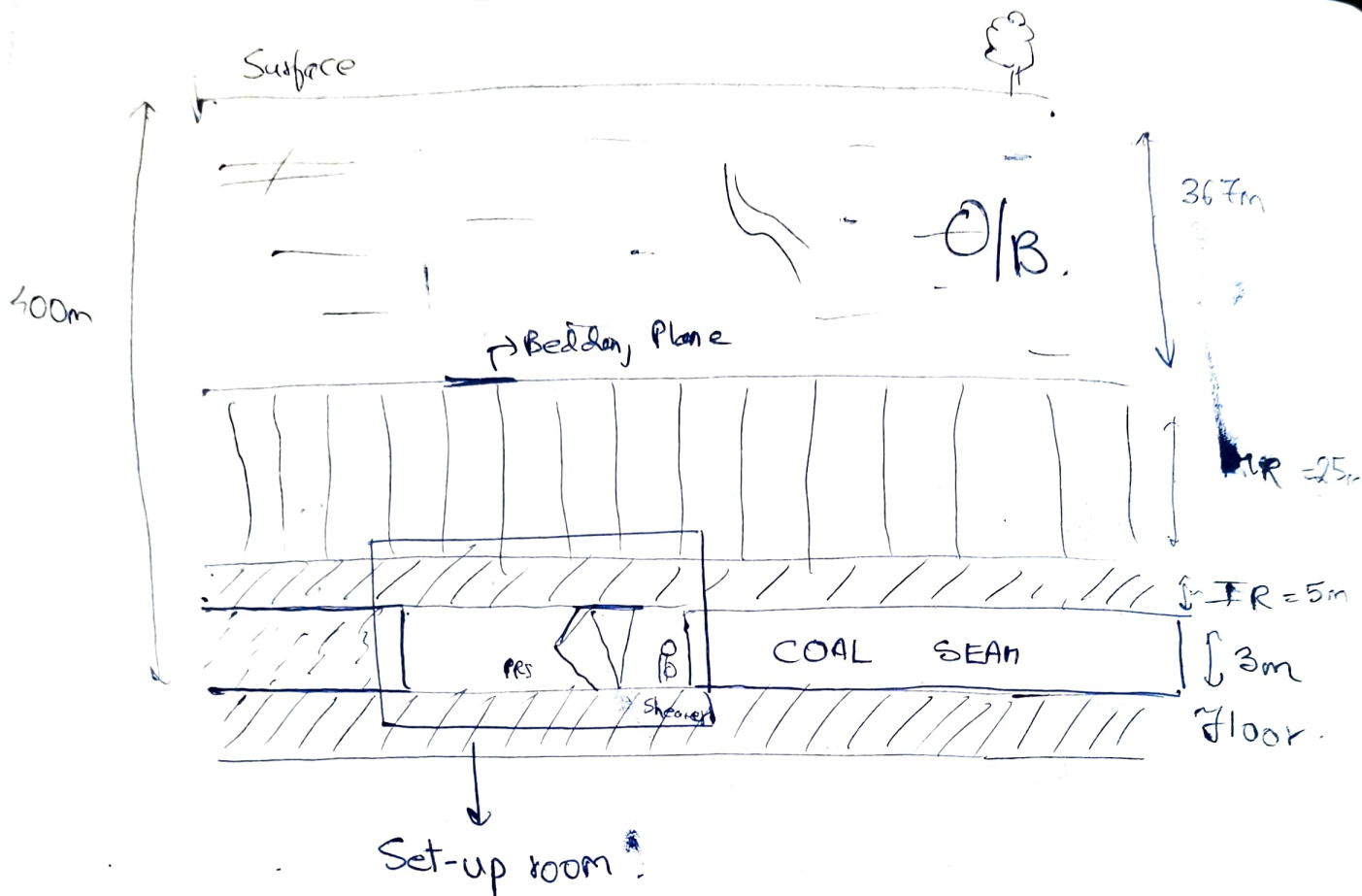
Face Length
(b).

Face (a)
Advance

- ① Local fall.
- ② Subsequent local fall.
- ③ Main fall.
- ④ Periodic caving.

Convergence Rate

Elastoplastic → elastoplastic
elastic



- Local fall → rock tries to fall from IR. (40/49m)
- plastic to elastoplastic deformation. (20m)

Now, plate converts to cantilever.

- Subsequent local fall → after local fall (30m).

- 2nd Subsequent local fall → (38m.)

- Main Fall → (60m) → Main Roof.

↳ load transfers to face

↳ main weighing.

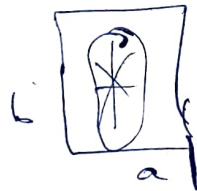
- Periodic Caving $\rightarrow$ load transfer is periodic weighting.
- $\rightarrow$ subsequent fallings of the main roof

* The spans depend on

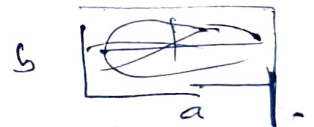
- ① Rate of advance.
- ② nature of roof.

* Kirchhoff's Plate Theory

- fracture propagate along longer dimension $\{a \text{ or } b\}$.
- then it forms star.



will
main
fall



will
main
fall

$a/b < 1 \Rightarrow$ more frequent caving

$a/b > 1 \Rightarrow$ longer time to cave

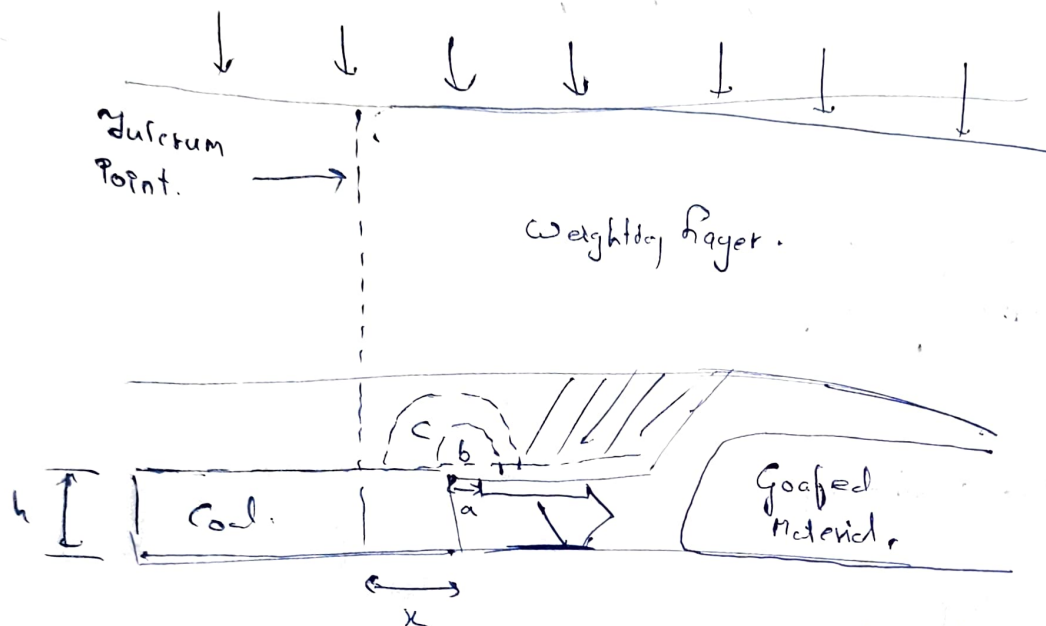
20/11/2025:-

For $a/b < 1 \Rightarrow$ caving is faster

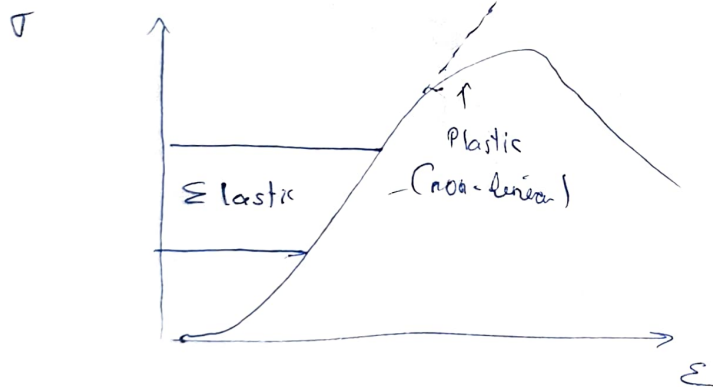
For $a/b > 1 \Rightarrow$ caving is delayed

} all other parameters
are fixed, we consider
only dimension.

1st



Stress - Strain Curve



b $\rightarrow$ guttering of roof
c $\rightarrow$ spelling distance

a $\rightarrow$ tip to face distance

$\downarrow$
roof cavity $\Rightarrow$ worst case scenario

- Face length $\uparrow$, BL ~~down~~ full face
- Face length $\downarrow$, BL further

2nd

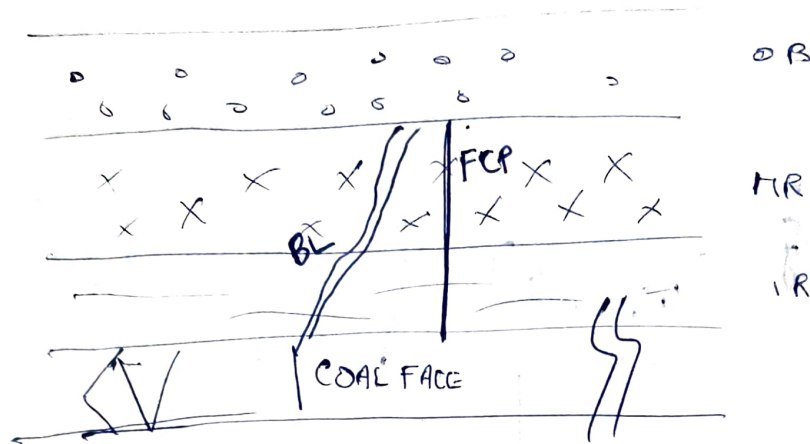
Fp $\rightarrow$ indication of bending of roof.

$\Rightarrow$ Elastic $\Rightarrow$ Bending.

Elastoplastic $\Rightarrow$ loading to face

- strain energy released

Case 1 :- Face length $>>$ Span or Main Fall.



BL $\rightarrow$ Breaker Line
FCP $\rightarrow$ Fulcrum Point

Reach BL $\Rightarrow$ mainfall will occur.
 $\rightarrow$ more pillar spalling.

~~$\rightarrow$ Total gap when BL is behind~~

$\rightarrow$ BL behind, larger gap may face second blast

Case 2 :- Face length $<$ Span/main fall.

India Scenario $\rightarrow$ Caving Zone = $12-15 \cdot H$

$\rightarrow$ Difficult to cave

$\rightarrow$ high bulk factor

$\rightarrow$ 80-85% Standstone

Low BF $\Rightarrow$ more volume to fall

$\rightarrow$ higher caving zone

Compacted goaf can be considered as regional support.

Abutment Stress Distribution :-

- Flat Jack → G-lens. (σ_{xx} σ_{yy} σ_{zz} τ_{xy} τ_{yz} τ_{xz})
- Hydrofracturing → all at once
- In situ stress, induced stress.

$$\sigma_H = \frac{\nu}{1-\nu} \sigma_v + \frac{\beta E G}{1-\nu} (1000 + H)$$

$$\text{or } \sigma_H = \frac{\nu}{1-\nu} \sigma_v$$

β = thermal expansion coefficient.

G = geothermal gradient.

ν → Poisson Ratio

H → depth of working

σ_H → mean horizontal stress.

$$\rightarrow \frac{\sigma_{H_1} + \sigma_{H_2}}{2}$$

→ avg of major and minor horizontal stress.

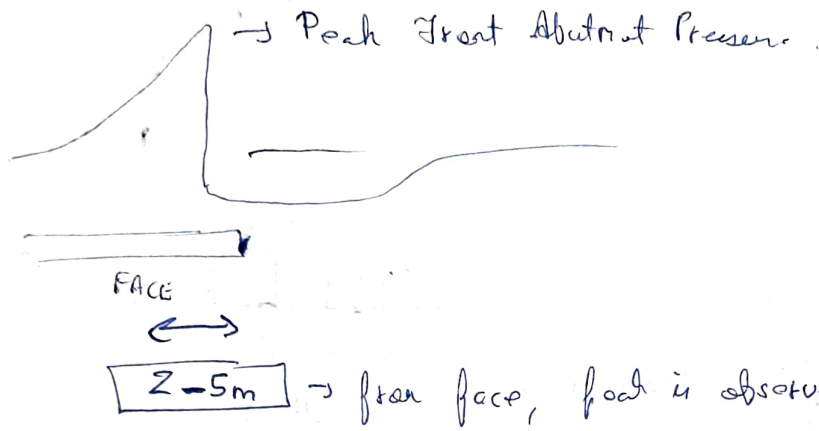
Abutment → solid takes stress

→ govt takes stress when it is compacted

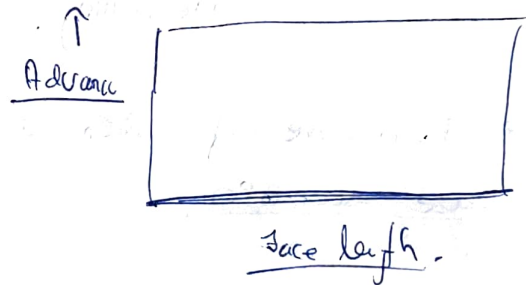
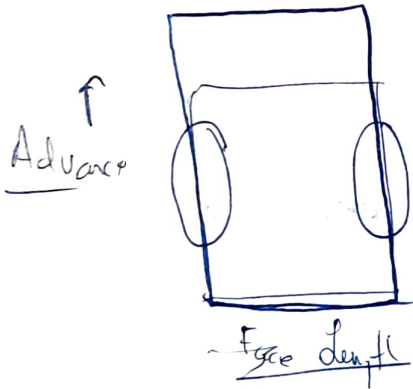
T-Junction → more stress

→ more superposition of stress.

Zone of influence = $\sqrt{20} \cdot a$

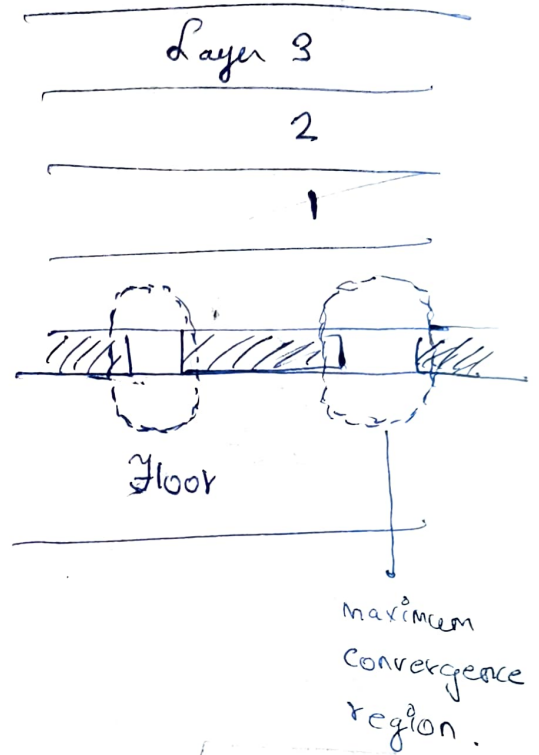
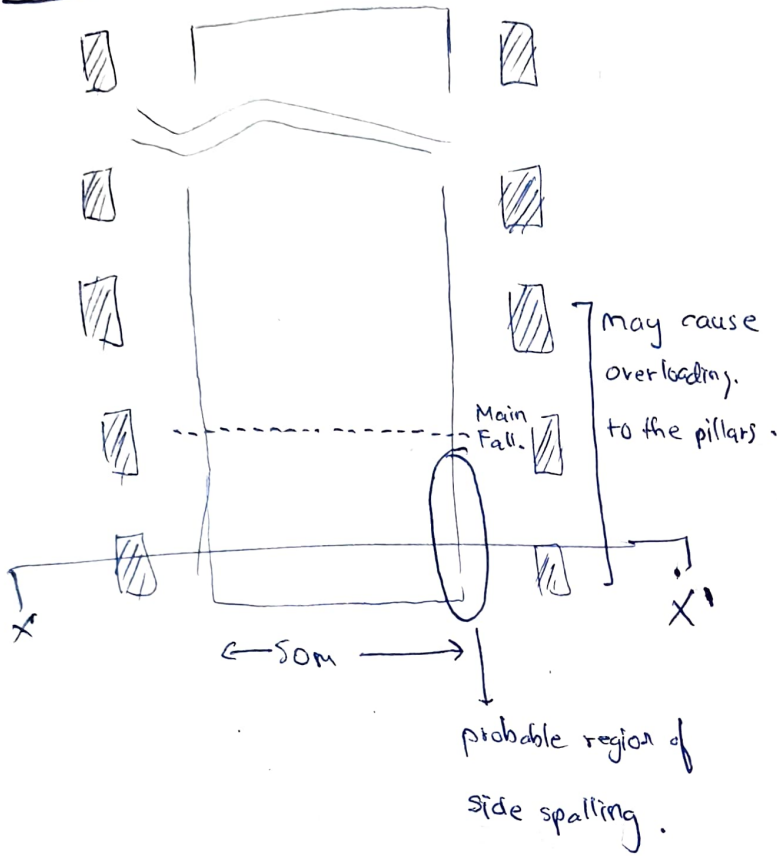


22/1/2025 :-



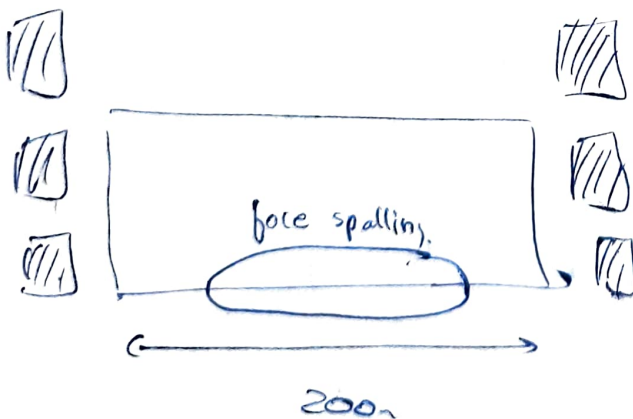
- Load at gables
- more convergency

Condⁿ 1 :-



⇒ this condⁿ at massive roof, when it is hard to cave. This is the worst case scenario

Condⁿ 2 :- Load at face ⇒ may cause face spalling.

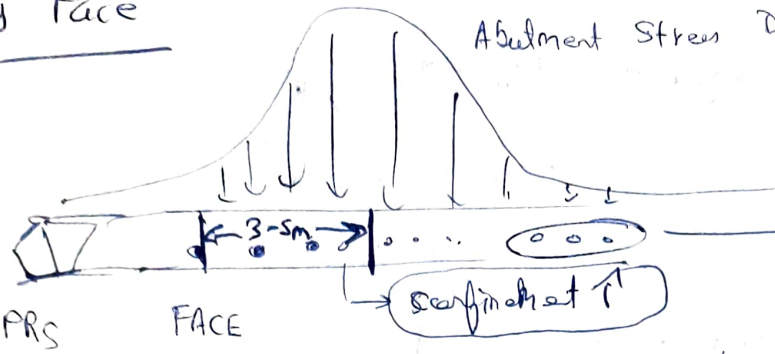


max^m load to face and PRS

Across Face

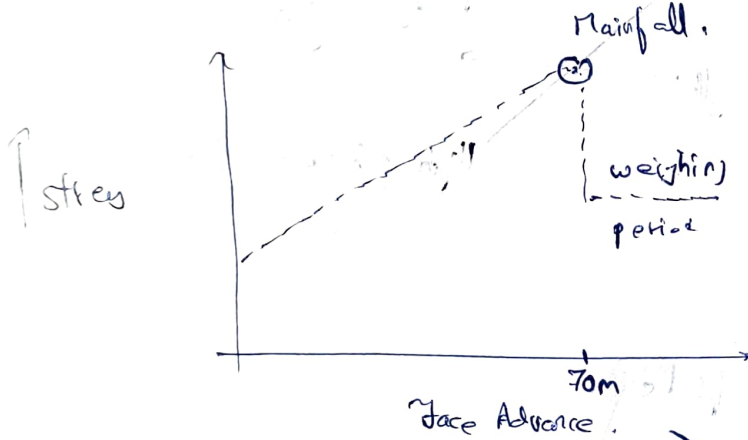
Abutment Stress Distribution.

??



it decrease, in-situ, why

→ Due to confinement, we don't get uniform stress distribution



→ monitor peak load with face advance. (confining & vert. zone.)

→ after max. stress, stress ↓

→ due to plasticity.

→ load transfer to face → face spalling.

→ main fall → load is now transferred

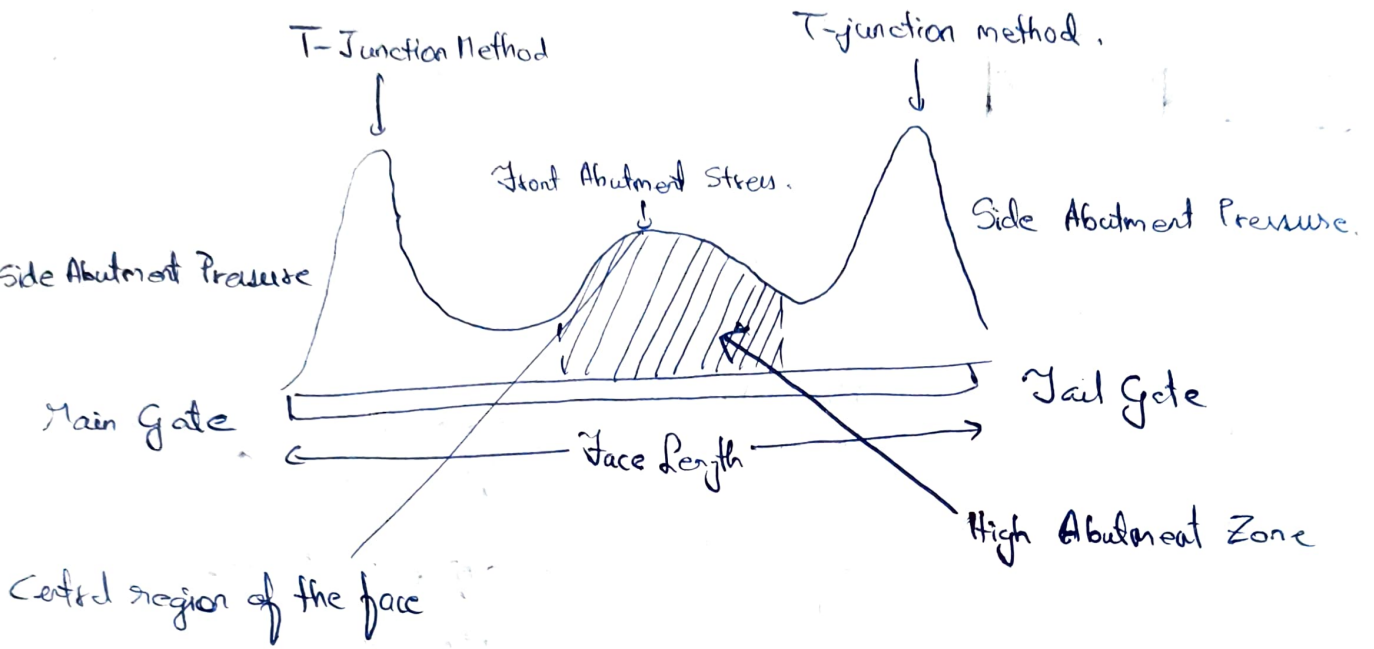
→ face length ↑, its domain of effect also ↑, so we have to find optimum.

→ control spalling of face after main fall, if not, it will go deeper

this cycle will be repeated till we finish

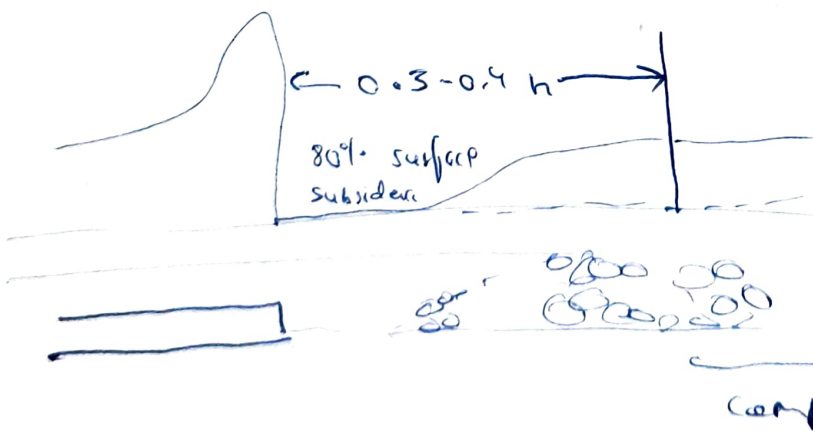
2.) Along the face.

• Stress redistribution ~~about~~ ~~by~~ ~~well~~ along length of face

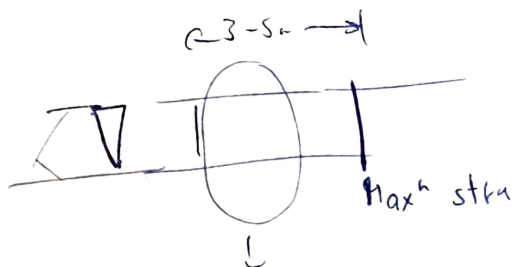


Centre $\rightarrow$ due to bending of plate
 T-junction $\rightarrow$ due to superimposition

Cover Pressure Distance $\Rightarrow$ goaf compact, it takes load
 $\rightarrow$ return to in-situ stress



• Zero stress near face, as goaf doesn't touch roof



low confinement, we not have
high stress, zone of max. damage,

22/1/2015:-

Weighting at the Face :-

• static cond, geominig parameters.

• Massive $\rightarrow$ high thickness high strength

• Thick Roof $\rightarrow$ low strength

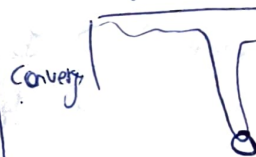


• En-masse caving.

$\Rightarrow$ high volume caving.

$\rightarrow$ sudden peak convergence

face advance



Yield Point $\rightarrow$ Bleeding of support

Narrow Roof $\rightarrow$ best into do induced blasting

$\rightarrow$ Support
 $\rightarrow$ face convergence } define weighting characteristic of LW.

Peak Stress $\Rightarrow$ Cave $\Rightarrow$ Weighting

Reflected as damage $\Rightarrow$ spalling



27/11/2025 :-

~~~~~

• Before each major fall, 3 conditions,

→ Normal Period → less convergence  
→ Peak Stress  
→ Weighting Period

→ Max convergence at centre

→ Worst Case Scenario

• Cavity ahead of powered support → collapse

⇒ secondary handling

⇒ first, we arrest cavity.

• grouting not possible, cavity too thick ⇒ wooden props.

• Convergence ↑ ⇒ Face spalling

⇒ Tip to face distance ↑.

Roof → laminated  
→ massive

→ Powered support 'west', then  
cavity / fulcrum advances  
away

• Bar from fulcrum → compression

→ try to deform in other direction

→ but there is compression from second

⇒ roof converge

• Guttering & Roof Cavity

↓  
local

(initial face)

↓  
main.

} both in front of support.

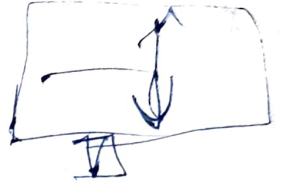
⇒ Support system should match with strata cond<sup>n</sup>.

⇒ Tensile Fracture ⇒ brecher line.

⇒ Centre ⇒ due to cantilever

Laminated ⇒ proper support

Mainve ⇒ brecher line just behind seffbat  
→ too much behind ⇒ wind blast.



→ Shortwall ⇒ causing delay. → induced blast.  
→ Roywall.

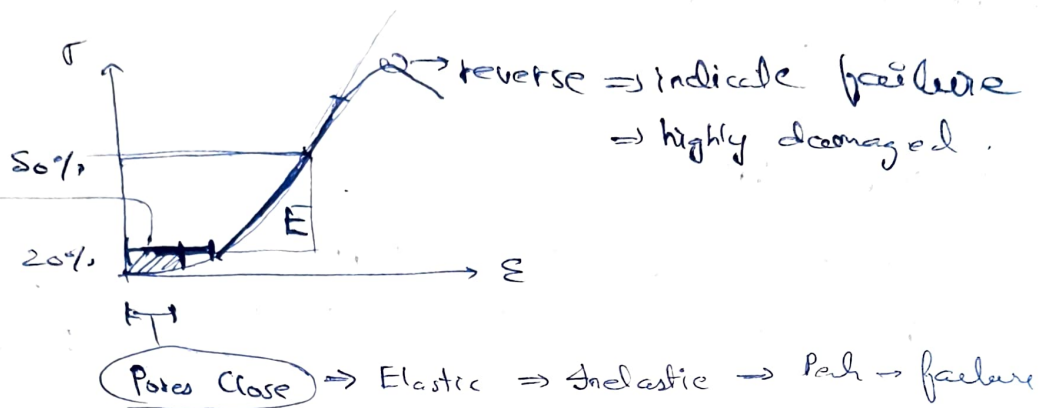
\* Thickness of main roof excessive → fracture difficult to propagate.  
→ induced blasting  
→ or increase face length.

→ Caving Shortwall → delay-l caving.

→ Bridging Shortwall, → no caving → ↑ face width.  
→ (cond<sup>n</sup> of caving not satisfied).

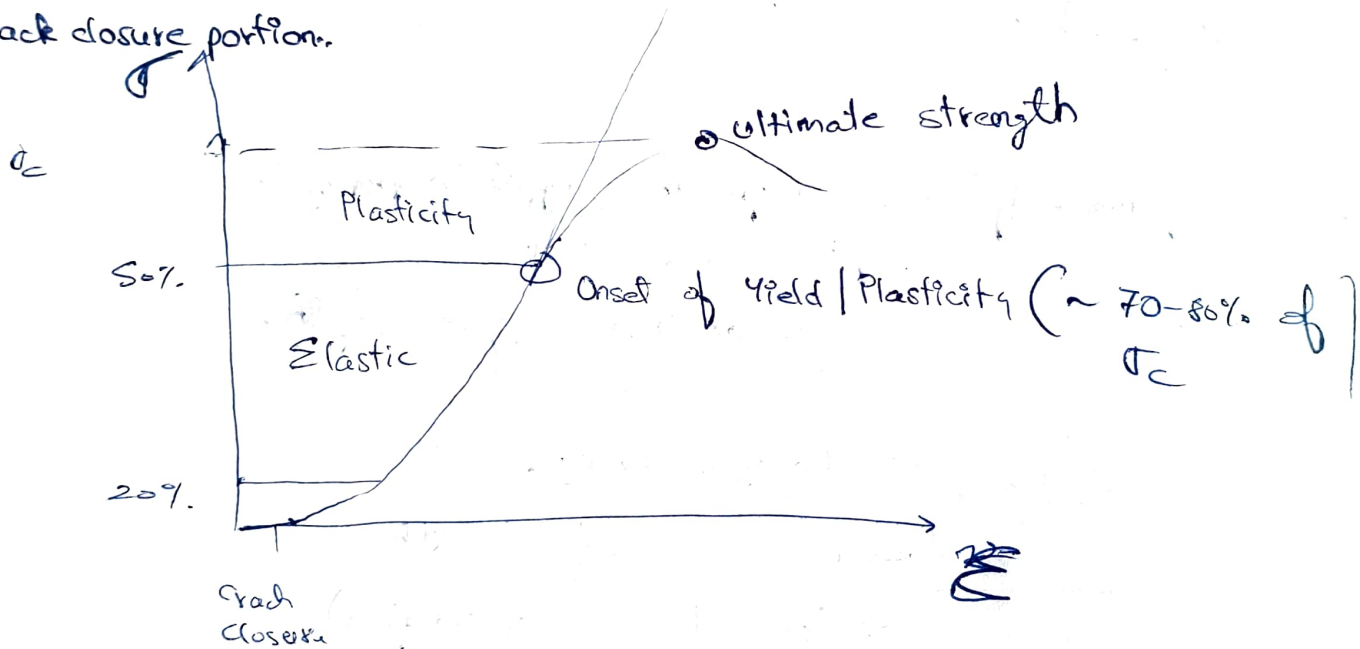
29/1/2025 :-

$\sigma_1 - \sigma_3 \rightarrow$  differential / differential stress



$\rightarrow$  to close pores.

$\rightarrow$  crack closure portion.



$\therefore$  After yield, crack damage propagates, then failure.

EIZ  $\rightarrow$  Excavation Influence Zone

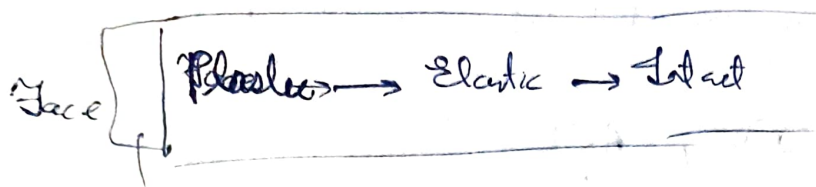
EDZ  $\rightarrow$  Excavation Damage Zone  $\rightarrow$  from withdrawal of linear  $\rightarrow$  plasticity zone

HDZ  $\rightarrow$  Highly Damaged Zone

$\rightarrow$  differentiated based on stress distribution.

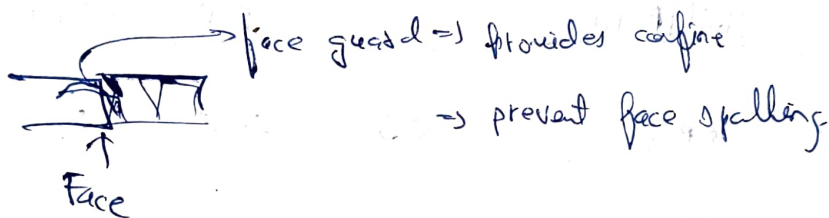
$\rightarrow$  analysis during peak stress period.





Damage Zone

- Normal Cond<sup>n</sup>
- Peak Cond<sup>n</sup>
- Weighting, Cond<sup>n</sup>.



→ Spalling from centre to top portion, propagation,  
 → because floor is strong rock, while top is coal  
 more confinement less confinement

o Jensen + Face Damage & Spalling

- Face advance should not stop, if so, loss & spalling propagation & ground control difficulty.

Roof Separation Index: (RSI)

- to determine thickness of intermediate, main roof.
- identify layers of rocks.

Caving Zone  $\rightarrow (12-15) \times \text{Working HE}$



→ 3x15 → 45 → till this we use PSI for intermolide / main-rock

Parameters :- UCS, RQD, ACL

↓  
avg. core length.

G<sub>total</sub>

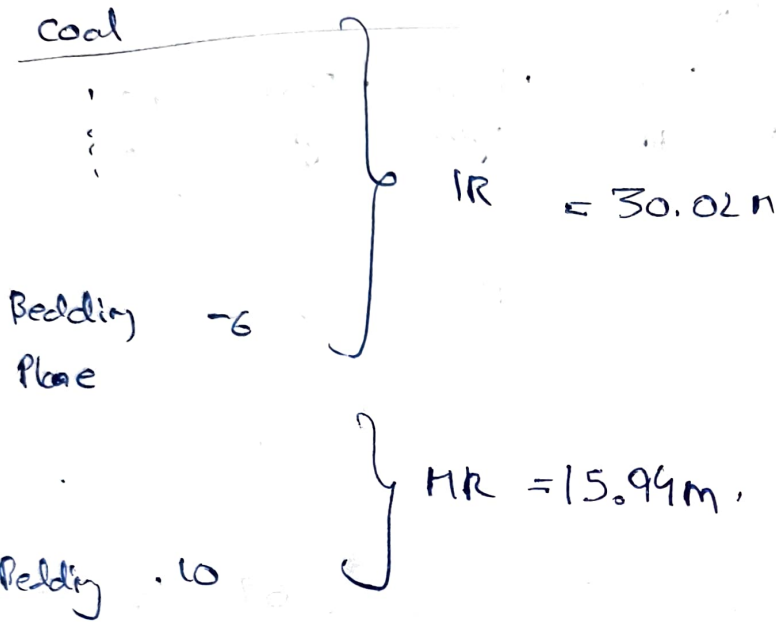
| Parameter                                        | Unit/Rating         | Rating Distribution |                 |         |         |      |
|--------------------------------------------------|---------------------|---------------------|-----------------|---------|---------|------|
| ① UCS.                                           | MPa                 | <5                  | 5-25            | 25-50   | >50     |      |
|                                                  | Rating.             | 1                   | 2               | 4       | 7       |      |
| ② RQD                                            | %                   | <25                 | 25-50           | 50-75   | 75-90   | >90  |
|                                                  | Rating.             | 3                   | 8               | 13      | 17      | 20   |
| ③ ACL                                            | cm                  | <5                  | 5-30            | 30-100  | 100-300 |      |
|                                                  | Rating.             | 5                   | 10              | 20      | 25      |      |
| ④ GW cond <sup>n</sup> /<br>wetness of<br>strat. | Cond <sup>n</sup> . | Dry                 | Water formation |         |         |      |
|                                                  | Rating.             | 10                  | 0               |         |         |      |
| ⑤ Bed<br>thickness.                              | m                   | <1.5                | 1.5-2.5         | 2.5-3.5 | 3.5-4.5 | ≥4.5 |
|                                                  | Rating.             | -28                 | -16             | -12     | -5      | 0    |

|                          |           |           |                                        |
|--------------------------|-----------|-----------|----------------------------------------|
| ⑥ Rock formation of bed. | Rock Type | Sandstone | Others (Shale, coal, clay, shaly coal) |
|                          | Rating.   | 0         | - 25                                   |

| Rock Type                 | Thickness | RQD % | $\sigma_c$ MPa | $\sigma_t$ MPa | Density kg/m <sup>3</sup> | E mod. GPa | ACL cm. |
|---------------------------|-----------|-------|----------------|----------------|---------------------------|------------|---------|
| Coal                      | 3         | 40    | 23.16          | 1.54           | 1400                      | 2          | 7.70    |
| Cgst, GW                  | 1.3       | 44    | 12.46          | 1.07           | 2050                      | 3.86       | 8.67    |
| Cgst, GW, Pebble          | 4         | 93    | 8.68           | 0.9            | 2040                      | 2.69       | 27.27   |
| Cgst, GW Pebble           | 3.7       | 77    | 8.68           | 0.9            | 2040                      | 2.69       | 13.70   |
| Cg to Fgst                | 6.53      | 94    | 12.93          | 1.15           | 2060                      | 4.01       | 19.2    |
| Cgst, GW Pebble           | 12.49     | 78    | 8.68           | 0.9            | 2040                      | 2.69       | 16.6    |
| Grey & carbonaceous clay  | 2         | 50    | 12.46          | 1.07           | 2050                      | 3.86       | 7.7     |
| Cgst, GW                  | 8.28      | 80.3  | 12.46          | 1.07           | 2050                      | 3.86       | 23.5    |
| Grey & carbonaceous clay. | 7.66      | 50    | 12.46          | 1.07           | 2050                      | 3.86       | 7.7     |
| Cgst GW                   | 8.54      | 69    | 12.46          | 1.07           | 2050                      | 3.86       | 14.4    |
| Cgst GW                   | 7.3       | 85    | 12.46          | 1.07           | 2050                      | 3.86       | 32.14   |
| OB                        | 150.3     |       |                |                |                           |            |         |

→ check for bedding plane.

RSI



∴ Qualify each layer  $\Rightarrow$  to be taken as IR or MR.

$\Rightarrow$  take weighted avg  $\Rightarrow \frac{\sum t \times (RQD \text{ or } \sigma_c \text{ or } \sigma_t)}{\sum t}$

RSI = Sum of (all 6)

$\Rightarrow$  Borehole data  $\Rightarrow$  Intact Rock

$\Rightarrow$  to be converted to rock mass

$$\sigma_{c \text{ Rock mass}} = \underbrace{0.5}_{\substack{\downarrow \\ \text{Scale} \\ \text{Factor}}} \times \sigma_{c \text{ Intact Rock}} \times RQD$$

$\Rightarrow$  Same for tensile

$$E = (0.31 \times \sigma_{c_{IR}}) \text{ GPa.}$$

Plane Strain and Plane Stress



31/1/2025 :-

IR  $\rightarrow$  30.02

MR  $\rightarrow$  15.99

|               | ucs | RQD | ACL | GW | Bed Thickness | bl for + dia | RSI |
|---------------|-----|-----|-----|----|---------------|--------------|-----|
| Coal          | 2   | 8   | 10  | 10 | -12           | -25          | -7  |
| Cgsst, GW     | 2   | 8   | 10  | 10 | -28           | 0            | 2   |
| Cgsst, GW     | 2   | 20  | 10  | 10 | -5            | 0            | 37  |
| Pebble        |     |     |     |    |               |              |     |
| Cgsst GW      | 2   | 17  | 10  | 10 | -5            | 0            | 37  |
| Pebble        |     |     |     |    |               |              |     |
| G to Fg       | 2   | 20  | 10  | 10 | 0             | 0            | 42  |
| rst           |     |     |     |    |               |              |     |
| Cgsst, GW     | 2   | 17  | 10  | 10 | 0             | 0            | 39  |
| Pebble        |     |     |     |    |               |              |     |
| Grey. carbon. | 2   | 13  | 10  | 10 | -16           | -25          | -6  |
| clay          |     |     |     |    |               |              |     |
| Cgsst, GW     | 2   | 17  | 10  | 10 | 0             | 0            | 39  |
| Grey, carbon. | 2   | 13  | 10  | 10 | 0             | -25          | 10  |
| clay          |     |     |     |    |               |              |     |
| Cgsst, GW     | 2   | 13  | 10  | 10 | 0             | 0            | 35  |
| Cgsst GW      | 2   | 17  | 20  | 10 | 0             | 0            | 39  |
| OB            |     |     |     |    |               |              |     |

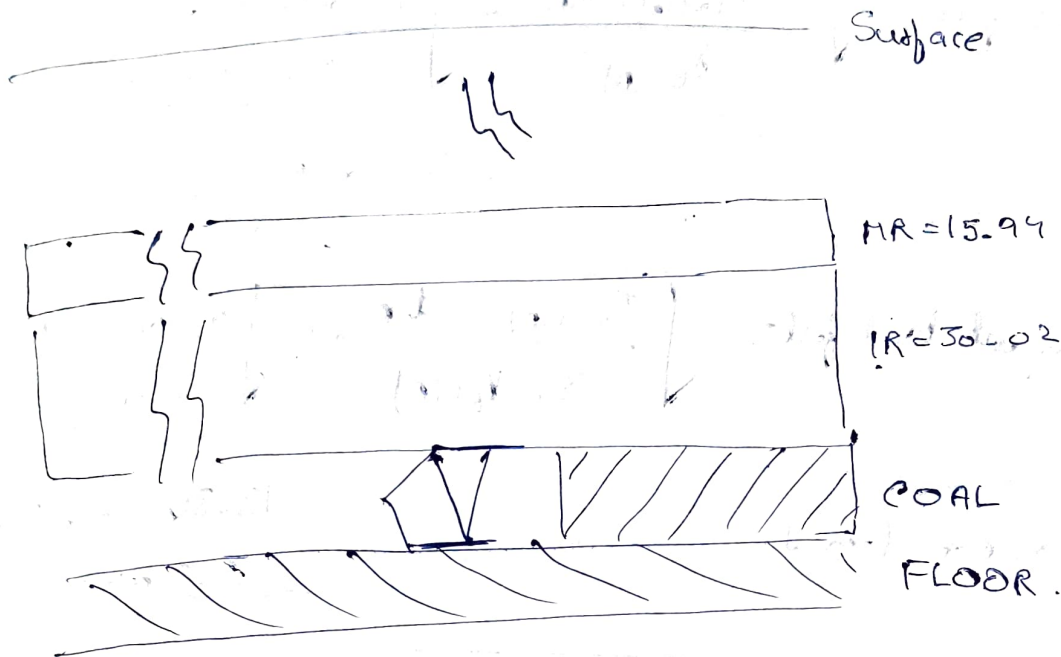
$$IR = 30.02m$$

$$IR = 15.94m$$



| Thickness |           |        |                                   |                        |                    |                    |
|-----------|-----------|--------|-----------------------------------|------------------------|--------------------|--------------------|
| IR        | 30.02     |        |                                   |                        |                    |                    |
| HR        | 15.94     |        |                                   |                        |                    |                    |
| Layer     | Thickness | $\rho$ | $\sigma_c$ (intact)<br>Comp. Str. | $\sigma_t$<br>(intact) | $\sigma_c$<br>(CR) | $\sigma_t$<br>(CR) |
| Coal.     | 3         | 1400   |                                   |                        |                    |                    |
| IR        | 30.02     | 2045   |                                   |                        |                    |                    |
| HR        | 15.94     | 2050   |                                   |                        |                    |                    |
| OB        | 166.34    | 2050   |                                   |                        |                    |                    |

| Layer | Thickness | $\rho$<br>kg/m <sup>3</sup> | PQD | $\sigma_c$<br>(CR) | $\sigma_t$<br>(CR) | $\sigma_c$<br>(CR)        | $\sigma_t$<br>(CR) |
|-------|-----------|-----------------------------|-----|--------------------|--------------------|---------------------------|--------------------|
| Coal  | 3         | 1400                        | 40  | 23.16              | 1.54               | 4.632                     | 0.308              |
| IR    | 30.02     | 2045                        | 80  | 10.02              | 0.97               | 4.008                     | 0.388              |
| HR    | 15.94     | 2050                        | 66  | 12.46              | 1.07               | <del>4.095</del><br>4.118 | 0.352              |
| OB    | 166.34    | 2050                        | 76  | 12.46              | 1.07               | <del>4.09</del><br>4.739  | <del>0.4066</del>  |



- i.) Local fall
- ii.) Subsequent local fall
- iii.) Main fall
- iv.) Periodic caving

} Beam Model  
 } Cantilever Model  
 } Beam Model  
 } Cantilever Model

$$\gamma_e \rightarrow \text{MPa/m}$$

Models used

$$\begin{aligned}
 &\rightarrow \text{① Beam model} \Rightarrow \frac{2 \times \sigma_{tm} \times t}{\gamma_e} \\
 &\rightarrow \text{② Cantilever model.} \Rightarrow \frac{\sigma_{tm} \times t}{3 \gamma_e}
 \end{aligned}$$

$\epsilon_w \rightarrow \text{Plane Strain.}$

$$\gamma_e \rightarrow \text{MPa/m} = \text{Eff. unit weight} \Rightarrow (\rho \times g \times 10^{-6}) \text{ MPa/m.}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
 \therefore \gamma_e(IR) &= 0.02096 \text{ MPa/m} \\
 \gamma_e(MR) &= 0.0205 \text{ MPa/m}
 \end{aligned}
 \quad (g = 10 \text{ considered})$$

## Local fall

$$\text{Span of local fall} = \sqrt{\frac{2 \times \sigma_{tm}(ir) \times t_{ir}}{\delta_{E(ir)}}} = \sqrt{\frac{2 \times 0.3625 \times 30.01}{0.02046}} \\ = 32.62 \text{ m}$$

$$\text{Span of subsequent local fall} = \sqrt{\frac{\sigma_{tm}(ir) \times t_{ir}}{3 \times \delta_{E(ir)}}} = \sqrt{\frac{0.3625 \times 30.01}{3 \times 0.02046}} \\ \text{can be more than 1} \quad = 13.318 + 32.62 \\ = 45.94$$

$$\text{Span of main fall} = \sqrt{\frac{2 \times 0.352 \times 15.94}{0.0205}} = 23.4 \text{ m} \\ = 23.4 + 45.94 \\ = 69.34$$

$$\text{Periodic Caving Span} = \sqrt{\frac{0.352 \times 15.94}{3 \times 0.0205}} = 9.55 \\ = 69.34 + 9.55 \\ = 78.89$$

- Not considered  $\rightarrow$  Rate of face advance & face width considered  $\rightarrow$  Mining operation.  
✓ no consideration of 3D, as it is 2D based

69.34  
32.62

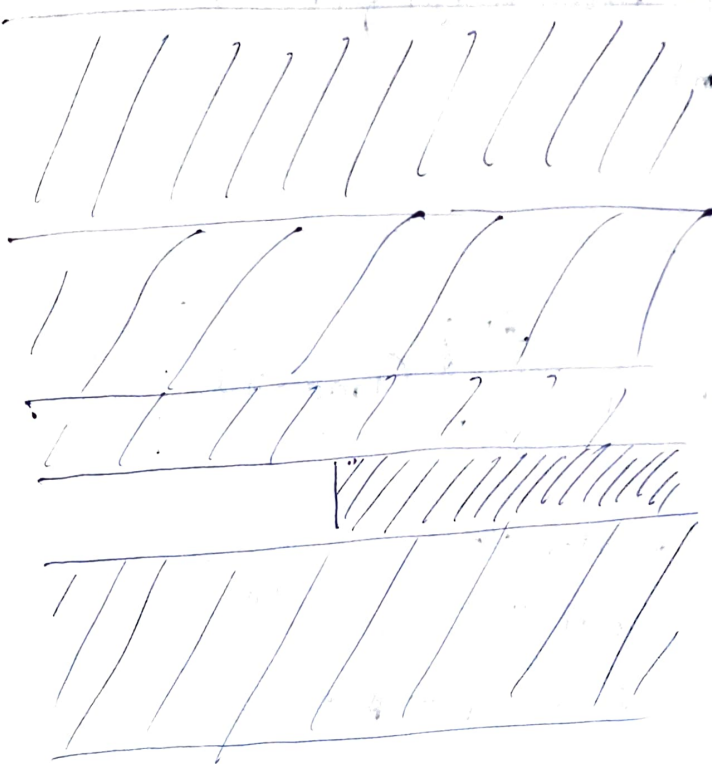
$$69.34 - 32.62 = 36.98$$

$$\frac{36.98}{13.818} \approx 3 \text{ subsequent local falls}$$

12/2/2026:-

Conceptual / Sequence of Caving:-

\* Relation taking face length effect



OB = 166.34m

Main Roof = 15.94m

Immediate Roof = 30.2m

Coal Seam = 3m

Floor = 50m

$$W_s = 324 \times (F.L.)^{-0.43} \times D^{-1.38} \times \sqrt{\frac{\sigma_{HIR} \times T_{IR}}{\gamma_{IR}}} \times \sqrt{\frac{\sigma_{HIR} \times T_{HR}}{\gamma_{HR}}}$$

$W_s \rightarrow$  weighing span (main fall span (m))

$\gamma \rightarrow$  unit cut,

$F.L. \rightarrow$  face length (m)

$D \rightarrow$  depth of working (m)

$\sigma_{HIR} / \sigma_{HMR} \rightarrow$  Equivalent tensile strength of HR or IR

$T \rightarrow$  thickness (m).

Q:  $F_h = 150m$ ;

$$\sigma_{hmean} = \frac{\nu}{1-\nu} \sigma_v + \frac{\rho E g}{1-\nu} (1000 + D)$$

$\sigma_{hmean} \rightarrow$  mean horizontal stress

$g \rightarrow$  geothermal gradient =  $0.03^\circ C/m$

$\beta \rightarrow$  co-efficient of thermal expansion.

$\rightarrow 8 \times 10^{-6} / ^\circ C \rightarrow$  ~~COAL~~ SANDSTONE

$\rightarrow 30 \times 10^{-6} / ^\circ C \rightarrow$  ~~SANDSTONE~~ COAL

$E \rightarrow$  Young's Modulus =  $3.1 GPa = 3.1 \times 10^3$

$\nu \rightarrow$  Poisson's Ratio = 0.25.

$\sigma_v \rightarrow$  Vertical Stress =  $\gamma D$  ;  $\gamma = 0.023 \text{ MPa/m}$



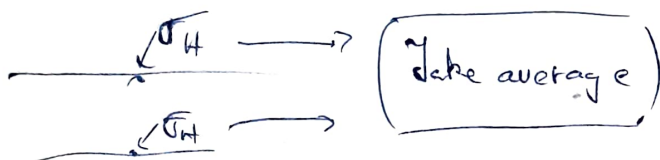
$$\sigma_{TIR} = \frac{(\sigma_{TIR} + \sigma_{hmean IR})}{100} \times RQD$$

equivalent

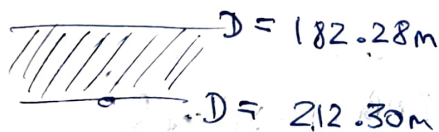
$\sigma_{TIR} \rightarrow$  tensile str. of IR.  $\Rightarrow$  ~~(INTACT ROCK)~~. (ROCK MASS)

$\sigma_{hmean IR} \rightarrow$  mean horizontal stress corresponding to IR

RQD  $\rightarrow$  Rock Quality Designation;



i) IR



$$\sigma_{hm}(\text{top}) = \frac{0.25}{0.75} \times (0.023 \times 182.28) + \frac{30 \times 10^{-6} \times 3.1 \times 10^3 \times 0.03}{0.75} \times$$

$$= \frac{5.795 \text{ MPa}}{(1000 + 182.28)} = 2.57 \text{ MPa}$$

$$\sigma_{hm}(\text{bottom}) = \frac{6.137 \text{ MPa}}{2.83 \text{ MPa}}$$

$$\sigma_{hm}(\text{avg}) = \frac{\sigma_{hm_t} + \sigma_{hm_b}}{2} = \frac{2.57 \text{ MPa} + 2.83 \text{ MPa}}{2} = 2.7 \text{ MPa}$$

$$\sigma_{TIR} = \frac{(2.7 + 0.388)}{100} \times 80 = 2.93 \text{ MPa} \quad 2.47 \text{ MPa}$$

ii) MB

$$\text{Top} \Rightarrow D = 166.34$$

$$\text{Bottom} \Rightarrow D = 182.284$$

$$E \rightarrow \sigma = 0.31 \times \sigma_c$$

$$\sigma_{hm}(\text{top}) = \frac{0.25}{0.75} \times (0.023 \times 166.34) + \frac{8 \times 10^{-6} \times 3.86 \times 10^3 \times 0.03 \times (1000 + 166.34)}{0.75}$$

$$= 2.72 \text{ MPa}$$

$$\sigma_{hm}(\text{bottom}) = 2.86 \text{ MPa}$$

$$\therefore \sigma_{hm} = \frac{2.72 + 2.86}{2} = 2.79 \text{ MPa}$$

$$\sigma_{MHR} = \frac{(2.79 + 0.352)}{100} \times 66 = 2.073 \text{ MPa} \rightarrow \text{tensile}$$

$$W_s = 324 \times (150)^{-0.43} \times (212.48)^{-1.38} \times \sqrt{\frac{2.47 \times 30.02}{0.02046}} \times \sqrt{\frac{2.073 \times 1594}{0.0205}}$$

$$W_s = 35.77 \text{ m}$$

$$(8 \times 10^{-6}) \text{ m/m}$$

\* Variation of D  $\rightarrow$  all of  $\sigma_{hm}$  changes

FL  $\rightarrow$  only  $W_s$  value varies

X

FLT  $\rightarrow$  High abutment Zone Increases depth wise

~~FLT~~

Face Height  $\uparrow \Rightarrow$  stiffness  $\downarrow$

Roof Thickness  $\uparrow \Rightarrow$  face stress conc.  $\uparrow \rightarrow$  face spalling

$$\text{Roof thickness Ratio} = \frac{MR}{IR}$$

\* Cavity Pressure  $\rightarrow$  Soft IR

17/2/25

$$S_v = 0.0014 D^{0.54} h^{1.96} L^{1.36} \sigma_{CIR}^{0.76} \sigma_{CNR}^{6.09} \sigma_{CCS}^{-0.39} T_R^{0.17} \left[ \frac{E_{IR} E_{IF}}{E_c^2} \right]^{-0.47}$$

$S_v \rightarrow$  spalled vol. of coal,  $m^3$

$D \rightarrow$  depth

$h \rightarrow$  mining height

$L \rightarrow$  face length

$\sigma_{CIR} \rightarrow \sigma_c$  of IR

$\sigma_{CNR} \rightarrow$  IR

$\sigma_{CCS} \rightarrow$  coal

$T_s \rightarrow$  thickness ratio of caving layers,  $\frac{T_{MR}}{T_{IR}}$

$T_{MR} \rightarrow$  MR

$T_{IR}$

$E_{IR} \rightarrow$   $\gamma_n$  of IR

$E_{IF} \rightarrow$   $\gamma_n$  of floor

$E_c \rightarrow$   $\gamma_n$  of coal

## \* Face Damage Severity Classification :-

- weighting period ↑ → more face spill ⇒ weighting checked
- coal strength, ht. of extraction ⇒ 2 variables ⇒ coal character.

↓  
 $\sigma_c$   
 $\sigma_t$

↓  
Standard  
variable.

## \* Weighting, Spalling and Face Advance Rate \*

- identify crit parameters,
- evaluate spill potential.
- estimate main weighting span,
- study face progress ⇒ quantify face advance, normal weighting period.
- develop relation.

$$\text{Drop Rate Face Progress} \mid \text{DRFP} = 25.583 + 0.092 S_v + 0.176 W_s$$

Web Cuts of Shearer → 0.8 v  $\rightarrow 0.8$  wt  
⇒ 0.6 - 0.7.

| Category of face dmg. | DRFP (%)                       | Class of severity of the face damage | Impact of face productivity |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| I Low                 | $\leq 45$                      | Low                                  | Nil.                        |
| II Mod                | $\geq 45\% \text{ \& } < 70\%$ | Moderate                             | Remains Manageable          |
| III High              | $\geq 70\%$                    | High                                 | Significant                 |

